Disappointment, even one as strictly relative as being dismissed carelessly for 147 in my final Test innings, has certain formalities. I've never been a bat-thrower, a blame-shifter or excuse-seeker. I prefer quick and quiet rationalization; my instinctive apology might have been a bit cloth-eared, but losing two wickets, especially those of well-set batsmen, to successive deliveries is a cardinal sin.

In time, it will be a killer pub-quiz question: name the Indian Test debutant who dismissed two England captains in two balls. Hanuma Vihari is an occasional right-handed off-spinner, a dispenser of what old pros refer to as 'filth'. There's no disrespect implied, intended or taken in that, by the way. It is merely our form of industrial language.

Rooty had holed out to midwicket for 125. In a world of fine margins, my mind wasn't locked in to the next ball. It was dragged down and I got a little greedy. Instead of making the slightly easier shot, in front of square, I acted on the momentary mental image of a thin gap between two fielders behind the wicket.

I wasn't consciously thinking of the boundary that would have taken me past 150, but I lacked that critical edge of concentration. I smiled and sagged forward, leaning on my bat momentarily, because I couldn't believe I had edged it to the wicketkeeper. All that was left was that final walk to the pavilion, bat aloft and brain whirring.

I noticed the dressing-room TV was replaying those scenes as I sat there, decompressing. The screen showed Alice, my wife, cradling our daughter Elsie and telling her 'there's Daddy'. I didn't cry, despite the temptation; the closest I came to doing so was during that amazing extended ovation for my second-innings century. There wasn't an ounce of me that wanted to carry on. I was done.

The only time in my career I wept uncontrollably was in the dressing room at the MCG during the Boxing Day Ashes Test in 2017. I was 104 not out at the close of play on the second day, on my way to carrying my bat for 244, and couldn't stop myself. I was as puzzled as anyone; on reflection, it was a moment of release after sustained private questioning of my mood and motives.

Retirement is not a snap decision, because representing your country is the greatest of an athlete's privileges. It rattles around the brain for months, sometimes years, and ambushes you when you least expect it to. For me the process began at Edgbaston in August 2017, during the first Test against the